

MORENIKE ATEJIOYE

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RESEARCH PROFILE

Urban planner and policy researcher with experience in long-range planning, mixed-methods community research, housing analysis, spatial analysis, and performance-oriented implementation. Research focuses on how public institutions use data, participation, and administrative systems to translate policy commitments into equitable outcomes.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Urban governance; data governance and performance management; comprehensive plan implementation; housing and employment accessibility; spatial inequality; public participation; equitable public-service delivery.

EDUCATION

Iowa State University, Ames, Iowa	2024
M.S., Community and Regional Planning	
Iowa State University, Ames, Iowa	2024
Graduate Certificate, Business Analytics	
Obafemi Awolowo University, Osun, Nigeria	2020
B.Sc., Urban and Regional Planning	

SELECTED RESEARCH PROJECTS

West Des Moines Inclusivity Index : Survey Report

Survey Team Lead | Collaborative Research Project, Iowa State University; 2024

Led the survey component of a collaborative study examining inclusivity in West Des Moines, contributing to survey development, data collection, analysis, interpretation, and preparation of the final report.

Citation: Atejioye, M., Rongerude, J., Moro, L., Snow-Perry, M., Fadoju, A., Gilliam, J., Son, H., Johnson, B., & Williamson, A. (2024). *West Des Moines Inclusivity Index: Survey Report*. <https://doi.org/10.31274/usp-20241220-2>

Employment Access and Housing Affordability in Omaha: Evaluating Patterns Consistent with the Spatial Mismatch Hypothesis – Research in progress

Examines spatial relationships among employment locations, housing affordability, transportation access, and neighborhood inequality using GIS and demographic, housing, and employment data.

From Vision to Accountability: A Comparative Evaluation of Equity, Implementation, and Monitoring in Municipal Comprehensive Plans – Graduate research paper, 2023; revised 2026

Applies a ten-criterion coding framework to compare the comprehensive plans of Marshalltown, Iowa; Walla Walla, Washington; and Ottumwa, Iowa, with emphasis on equity, public participation, implementation, and monitoring.

AI-Driven Housing Evaluation for Rural Community Development – Data Science for the Public Good, 2023

Collaborated with an interdisciplinary team to develop predictive and visualization models for public housing datasets and translated findings into accessible outputs for public-sector use.

RESEARCH AND PLANNING EXPERIENCE

City of Omaha – Planning Department, Omaha, Nebraska	Jun 2024–Present
Long-Range City Planner	
Conduct mixed-methods research for Omaha’s 30-year comprehensive plan, integrating survey, workshop, focus-group, interview, demographic, and spatial data into policy recommendations.	
Analyzed more than 50,000 citywide survey responses to identify differences in priorities by age, income, and location.	
Prepare research reports, policy memoranda, data visualizations, maps, growth scenarios, and implementation frameworks for staff, advisory groups, elected officials, and the public.	
Contributed to a citywide Data Book and Trend Book and developed approaches for tracking comprehensive-plan implementation and community outcomes.	
Co-authored a proposal for a centralized Data and Research Department to improve data standards, institutional knowledge retention, and public access to City data.	

RESEARCH AND PLANNING EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

Iowa State University — Extension and Outreach, Ames, Iowa Jul 2023–May 2024

Research Assistant

Supported housing inventory development and regional housing research for multi-state working groups.
Compiled and analyzed datasets and prepared policy briefs, research summaries, and engagement materials for academic and practitioner audiences.

Iowa State University - Data Science for the Public Good May–Jul 2023

Graduate Fellow

Applied predictive modeling and data visualization to public housing datasets and public-sector planning questions.
Mentored undergraduate students in applied data science, research workflows, and communicating analytical findings.

Iowa State University — Community and Regional Planning Aug 2022–May 2023

Teaching Assistant

Facilitated class discussions, assessed student work, supported course delivery, and maintained academic records.

Energy Talent Company, Abuja, Nigeria Aug 2021–Aug 2022

Research Associate / Program Associate / Business Analyst

Conducted workforce, market, survey, and program research for renewable-energy training initiatives and translated findings into program design and assessment.

GABLE Consults, Lagos, Nigeria Mar 2020–Aug 2022

Urban Planner

Prepared socioeconomic, land-use, and environmental analyses; coordinated planning projects; and produced interactive maps and project databases.

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS AND PANELS

Presenter: IAP2 2025 National Conference; IAP2 2024 Midwest Conference; 2025 Nebraska Planning Conference.

Peer Review: 2026 APA National Planning Conference.

Panelist: 2025 CPAR Data and Research Series for Community Impact, University of Nebraska Omaha.

Additional presentations delivered to neighborhood associations and community organizations on comprehensive planning and public engagement.

SELECTED RESEARCH AND POLICY OUTPUTS

Citywide Data Book and Trend Book for the Omaha Comprehensive Plan — author, 2024–Present.

Public engagement findings reports and scenario analyses for We Make Omaha — lead analyst, 2024–Present.

Proposal for a Centralized Data and Research Department, City of Omaha — co-author, 2026.

Regional housing inventories, policy briefs, and research summaries for Iowa State University Extension working groups — contributor, 2023–2024.

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Data Science for the Public Good Graduate Fellowship, Iowa State University 2023

RESEARCH AND TECHNICAL SKILLS

Research Methods	Mixed-methods research; comparative case analysis; policy and plan evaluation; survey design and analysis; qualitative coding; community-engagement analysis; program evaluation.
Data and Analytics	Python; R; SQL; SPSS; Advanced Excel; Power BI; Tableau; TidyCensus.
GIS and Visualization	ArcGIS Pro; ArcGIS Online; StoryMaps; spatial analysis; AutoCAD; Adobe InDesign; Visio.